

Beacon Digest -- 2026-09-30

Linux

Firefox 157.0 released

Source: *LWN.net*

Version 157.0 of the Firefox browser has been released. It features " Firefox's biggest visual refresh in years ", the ability to use hardware AV1 decoding with WebRTC calls, and a number of fixes.

[\$] Native support for Rust on the GPU

Source: *LWN.net*

Christian Legnitto is the maintainer of rust-gpu and Rust CUDA , two libraries that make it possible to program a computer's graphics processing unit (GPU) from Rust. He isn't satisfied with the current state of GPU support in Rust, however. In a talk at RustConf 2026 , he explained his vision for h...

[\$] The kernel from a PostgreSQL point of view

Source: *LWN.net*

Andres Freund has a few claims to fame , but chief among them is his many years of work to improve the performance of the PostgreSQL relational database management system. That work requires working with — or around — many Linux kernel features and behaviors. He put in an appearance at the 2026 edit...

Security updates for Tuesday

Source: *LWN.net*

Security updates have been issued by AlmaLinux (cockpit-image-builder, expat, ipa, kernel, kernel-rt, resteasy, ruby, ruby4.0, ruby:3.3, and ruby:4.0), Debian (dovecot, flatpak, glance, kernel, libdbi-perl, lxml, rsync, swift, and wordpress), Fedora (chromium, freeipa, freerdp, grub2, NetworkManager...

Fedora Badges Revamp Project: From The Ground Up

Source: *Fedora Magazine*

After years of technical research and foundational work, the Fedora Badges application service has been rebuilt from the ground up, and it is heading to production. Whether you have been collecting badges for years or you are brand new to the Fedora Project community, here is what is waiting for you...

Test Days for Fedora 45: Help Us Test the Big Changes

Source: Fedora Magazine

Fedora 45 has several system-level changes that need testing on real hardware. The first test day up is GNOME 51, starting on 17 August, with more events planned for RPM 6.1, installation media and others. You can participate with a VM for most tests; some hardware-specific testing is more useful on...

Why Red Hat is building an open foundation for enterprise agents with OpenClaw Enterprise

Source: Red Hat Blog

Applications are moving beyond predefined workflows toward agentic systems that can reason, use tools, interact with enterprise data, execute code, delegate work and collaborate with other agents to accomplish goals. This has driven the development of new capabilities in areas like agent sandboxing...

Red Hat delivers peak performance on Kubernetes and CPUs in MLPerf Inference v6.1

Source: Red Hat Blog

Red Hat is proud to announce our results from the industry-standard MLPerf Inference v6.1 benchmark. This submission builds on our track record across recent rounds: In v5.1, we demonstrated cost-effective Llama-3.1-8B-FP8 inference with vLLM on NVIDIA H100 and L40S GPUs, and in v6.0 we delivered re...

Balancing open science and data privacy with enterprise Red Hat OpenShift AI

Source: Red Hat Blog

At the OpenShift Commons gathering in Amsterdam on March 23—the high-energy "Day Zero" event of KubeCon and CloudNativeCon Europe 2026—the stage was set for a deep dive into the intersection of cutting-edge technology and global safety. Francesco Giannoccaro, Head of High Performance Computing at th...

Agentic AI for network operations: Smarter decisions on proven automation

Source: Red Hat Blog

Most telecommunications service providers already know how to manage changes to their network. They have established change windows, built approved playbooks, and used network automation over many years to make the process more reliable. The challenging part isn't implementing the change, it's decidi...

Partner recognition: Red Hat's placement as a Leader in the 2026 Gartner® Magic Quadrant™ for Container Management

Source: Red Hat Blog

We are proud to announce that Red Hat has been named a Leader in the 2026 Gartner® Magic Quadrant™ for Container Management for the fourth consecutive year. As enterprise IT organizations scale modern container infrastructure across diverse cloud environments while rapidly adopting artificial intelli...

Partner success: Leveraging Red Hat's recognition in 2026 Gartner Magic Quadrant reports

Source: Red Hat Blog

We are excited to share that Red Hat has been named a Leader again in the 2026 Gartner Magic Quadrant for Cloud-Native Application Platforms! For our partners, this recognition is more than just a headline—it is a powerful tool to engage with your customers and showcase the exceptional value that Red...

Red Hat Named a Leader in the 2026 Gartner Magic Quadrant for server virtualization platforms

Source: Red Hat Blog

Red Hat is proud to be named a Leader in the 2026 Gartner® Magic Quadrant™ for server virtualization platform1. This recognition is driven by our completeness of vision and ability to execute, and we believe it is marking a significant milestone in the evolution of modern hybrid infrastructure. A un...

Accelerating growth at Ecosystem Success Day 2026

Source: Red Hat Blog

Red Hat's Ecosystem Success Day 2026 focused on exploring how open collaboration and innovation are reshaping customer value and fostering mutual profitability. The half-day event emphasized that speeding business growth relies heavily on a thriving network of partners. Winning together During the key...

Security

Attackers Exploit NetScaler Flaw for Root Access, Deploy WHIPSHOT and SLAPSHOT

Source: The Hacker News

Unknown threat actors have been observed exploiting a newly patched security flaw in Citrix NetScaler ADC and NetScaler Gateway appliances to target

organizations in North America and Europe. The activity, observed by Mandiant Consulting and Google Threat Intelligence Group (GTIG) in September 2026,...

OpenSSL Fixes High-Severity DTLS Flaw That Can Leak Heap Memory Unencrypted

Source: The Hacker News

A High-severity OpenSSL flaw can leak heap memory to the other side of a DTLS connection or crash the program, OpenSSL said on September 29 as it released fixes. DTLS, the TLS variant used for UDP traffic, resends a handshake message if no reply arrives before the timer expires. The leak or crash ca...

Citrix NetScaler CVE-2026-88772 Exploit Details Show Pre-Auth Path to Shellcode Execution

Source: The Hacker News

Cybersecurity researchers have disclosed technical details of a recently patched critical security flaw in Citrix NetScaler ADC and Gateway that has come under active exploitation in the wild. The vulnerability, tracked as CVE-2026-88772 (CVSS score: 9.5), has been described as a memory overflow bug...

French Tax Data Theft Using Stolen Staff Passwords Went Undetected for Seven Weeks

Source: The Hacker News

An attacker used stolen passwords of staff at France's tax administration to take tax data on hundreds of thousands of taxpayers and businesses in June and July. Neither the tax administration nor France's national cybersecurity agency saw the data leave. The attack was not sophisticated, the agency...

New Spectre-v2 BTR Attack Leaks Linux Memory Despite Existing Defenses

Source: The Hacker News

A group of academics from VUsec and Scuola Superiore Sant'Anna have disclosed details of a new Spectre CPU vulnerability variant that affects Just-In-Time (JIT) engines present in web browsers, language runtimes, and the operating system kernel, across multiple CPU vendors. The new Spectre v2 varian...

Russia's Star Blizzard Targets 100+ Organizations With Fake Event Invites to Deliver Backdoor

Source: The Hacker News

Russian state hackers known as Star Blizzard have been using fake event invitations to trick people into installing a backdoor on their Windows computers,

according to Microsoft. The campaigns, aimed at people and organizations tied to Ukraine, have affected more than 100 organizations since January...

Kiteworks Fixes Critical Flaw Found During Nine-Hour Precautionary Shutdown

Source: *The Hacker News*

Kiteworks on Monday said it worked with federal intelligence authorities over the weekend as it identified and addressed a critical security vulnerability during the scheduled precautionary shutdown. "During the shutdown, this activity led to the discovery of a previously unknown critical vulnerabil...

101 Malicious npm Packages Add Developers' WhatsApp Accounts to Groups Without Consent

Source: *The Hacker News*

Cybersecurity researchers have identified a cluster of 101 npm packages that are used to trap developers into a WhatsApp group subscriber campaign dubbed PhantomSub. "The malicious packages abuse the 'Baileys' WhatsApp open source project to add the victims to groups without their consent," OX Secur...

General Tech

GPT-6.1 Sol replaces GPT-6 Sol after just 7 days, with near-Astra intelligence

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://artificialanalysis.ai/articles/gpt-6-1-sol-replaces-gpt-6-sol-after-just-7-days-with-near-astra-intelligence> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49906669> Points: 12 # Comments: 8

Pi.dev: You Said No MCP

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://earendil.com/posts/you-said-no-mcp/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49906637> Points: 67 # Comments: 25

Why Is Sam Altman a Free Man?

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://prospect.org/2026/09/29/artificial-intelligence-agents-openai-microsoft-sam-altman-greg-brockman-ah-nice/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49905633> Points: 128 # Comments: 86

September 2026: The world today, as seen by one Polish guy

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://tomwojcik.com/posts/2026-09-21/september-2026-the-world-today/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49905487> Points: 270 # Comments: 143

RSS Feeds for Last.fm

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://lfm.xiffy.nl/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49903862> Points: 81 # Comments: 17

Floppy Emu Hardware Failure Analysis Results

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://www.bigmessowires.com/2026/09/29/floppy-emu-hardware-failure-analysis-results/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49902093> Points: 12 # Comments: 3

NRC issues first U.S. construction permit for a BWRX-300 small modular reactor

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://www.gevernova.com/news/press-releases/nrc-issues-first-us-construction-permit-bwr-300-small-modular-reactor-tva-clinch-river> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49902019> Points: 44 # Comments: 15

Livenerf: Has Opus 5.5 been nerfed yet?

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://github.com/ninjahawk/livenerf> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49901736> Points: 654 # Comments: 261

U.S. postal inspectors shut down website selling counterfeit postage labels

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://postalemployeenetwork.com/news/2026/09/26/u-s-postal-inspectors-shut-down-website-selling-millions-of-counterfeit-postage-labels/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49899090> Points: 236 # Comments: 139

Show HN: Real-time Solar System with 526k asteroids and all tracked satellites

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://space.b12.net/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49898778> Points: 266 # Comments: 64

Vermont replacing power plants with home batteries

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

See also <https://electrek.co/2026/07/28/vermonts-largest-energy-sourc...>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49897993> Points: 214 # Comments: 168

Dots: Always-on agents

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://openai.com/index/introducing-dots/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49896604> Points: 635 # Comments: 496

GPT 6.1 Sol: Near-Astra intelligence for a fifth of the price

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://openai.com/index/introducing-gpt-6-1-sol/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49896586> Points: 960 # Comments: 842

Needed 1+1, built a functional programming language

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://hereticpleb.vercel.app/blog/needed-one-plus-one/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49895864> Points: 114 # Comments: 35

PS5 Relapse Exploit

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://github.com/ntfargo/Relapse-Exploit> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49895304> Points: 314 # Comments: 190

America.gov

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://america.gov/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49893509> Points: 583 # Comments: 488

Ask HN: What are you reading?

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

I'm plowing through the Dungeon Crawler Carl series, which is not particularly challenging as sci-fi/LitRPG goes, but entertaining enough. I'm also wrapping up Doctorow's *Enshittification*, and I'm looking for something a little meaty to keep the brain working... Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49893002>

Backblaze drive stats for Q2 2026

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://www.backblaze.com/blog/backblaze-drive-stats-for-q2-2026/>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49893002> Points: 204 #
Comments: 60

How Delhi cut electricity loss from 50 to 5 percent

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://spectrum.ieee.org/delhi-electricity-loss> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49892245> Points: 530 # Comments: 296

Language models for text classification: From bag-of-words to Jev

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://magazine.sebastianraschka.com/p/classifier-history-and-jev>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49891203> Points: 134 #
Comments: 5